Topic 19 — Climate & Environmental Institutions

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

IPCC (आईपीसीसी) | UNEP (संयुक्त राष्ट्र पर्यावरण कार्यक्रम) | UNDP (यूएनडीपी) | IUCN (आईयूसीएन) | WWF (डब्ल्यूडब्ल्यूएफ) | FAO (Environment-related Role)

Sources baked in: IPCC AR6, UNEP reports, UNDP HDR, IUCN Red List, WWF Living Planet Report, FAO SOFO, UPPCS PYQs 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ High — org ↔ report ↔ HQ matching **Last verified:** August 2026

Current Affairs (this topic)

- IPCC AR cycle and UNEP / WMO headlines are institutional CA.
- Keep UNFCCC (यूएनएफसीसीसी) Secretariat vs IPCC role split clear.

19.1 IPCC

Identity: 1988 WMO+UNEP | Geneva | Assessment Reports | Nobel 2007 | Not policy body

- The **IPCC (Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (जलवायु परिवर्तन))** was established in **1988** by **WMO** and **UNEP**.
- It provides governments with **scientific assessments** of climate change, impacts, and response options.
- **Headquarters** is in **Geneva, Switzerland**.
- IPCC publishes **Assessment Reports (AR)** roughly every 5–7 years. **AR6** was completed in **2023**.
- **Working Group I** covers physical science. **WG II** covers impacts and adaptation. **WG III** covers mitigation.
- The **Special Report on 1.5°C (2018)** was important for Paris Agreement (पेरिस समझौता) ambition.
- IPCC shared the **Nobel Peace Prize in 2007** with Al Gore.
- IPCC **synthesises existing science**. It does **not** conduct primary research or set emission targets.
- **UNFCCC** (यूएनएफसीसीसी) is the **treaty body** where countries negotiate **NDCs** at **COP** meetings. IPCC informs but does not decide policy.

Logic: "IPCC sets Paris Agreement targets" = **false**.

Body	Role
IPCC	**Science assessment**

Body	Role
UNFCCC	**Treaty negotiations**

19.2 UNEP

Identity: Stockholm 1972 (स्टॉकहोम सम्मेलन) | Nairobi HQ | Emissions Gap | GEO | MEA secretariats

- **UNEP** was created by the **Stockholm Conference (1972)** (स्टॉकहोम सम्मेलन) as the UN's principal environmental authority.
- **Headquarters** is in **Nairobi, Kenya** — the only major UN environment HQ in the Global South.
- UNEP publishes the annual **Emissions Gap Report** on the shortfall between NDC pledges and **1.5°C/2°C** pathways.
- **GEO (Global Environment Outlook)** is UNEP's comprehensive state-of-environment assessment.
- UNEP hosts or supports secretariats for treaties like **Montreal, Basel, Stockholm POPs, and Minamata**.
- UNEP co-created **IPCC** with WMO but the **Emissions Gap Report is UNEP's own product**, not an IPCC report.
- The **Global Environment Facility (GEF)** (जीईएफ) was established in **1991** and finances projects under UNFCCC, CBD, Montreal, and other conventions. UNEP is one implementing agency.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q6

Emissions Gap Report → Options include UNEP (2), UNDP (3)

Show answer

Ans: UNEP (2) — Full match: HDR→UNDP(3), WEO→IMF(1), WIR→UNCTAD(4), Emissions Gap→UNEP(2) = **A (3 1 4 2)**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q145

1. GEF established in 1991.
2. Only developed countries are donors.

Show answer

Ans: D (Only 1) — GEF **1991** true; donors not **only** developed countries.

19.3 UNDP

Identity: New York | HDR 1990 | HDI | Mahbub ul Haq + Amartya Sen

- **UNDP** is the UN's global **development** network working on poverty, governance, and SDG implementation.
- **Headquarters** is in **New York**.

- The first **Human Development Report (HDR)** was published in **1990** and introduced the **Human Development Index (HDI)**.
- **HDI** combines **life expectancy**, **education**, and **GNI per capita (PPP)**.
- HDI was developed by **Mahbub ul Haq** and **Amartya Sen** — **not** S. Priesner.
- UNDP supports **SDG localisation** and climate/biodiversity projects but is **not** the Emissions Gap publisher.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q132

1. UNDP published first HDR with HDI in 1990.
2. HDI team led by Mahbub-ul-Haq and S. Priesner.

Show answer

Ans: D (Only 1) — Statement 2 false; Sen not Priesner.

Report	Publisher
Human Development Report	**UNDP**
Emissions Gap Report	**UNEP**

19.4 IUCN

Identity: 1948 Gland | Red List | Threatened = VU+EN+CR | Not CITES

- **IUCN** is a global conservation union of states and NGOs, founded in **1948**.
- **Headquarters** is in **Gland, Switzerland**.
- The **IUCN Red List** is the standard system for assessing **extinction risk** of species.
- Categories include **LC, NT, VU, EN, CR, EW, EX** plus DD and NE.
- **Threatened species** (संकटग्रस्त प्रजातियां) means **Vulnerable + Endangered + Critically Endangered (VU + EN + CR)**.
- IUCN **assesses scientific risk**. It does **not** regulate international trade — **CITES** does that.
- IUCN provides scientific input to **CBD and CITES** but is a separate organisation.

> **Logic:** "IUCN bans wildlife trade" = **false** — **CITES** regulates trade.

19.5 WWF

Identity: NGO Gland | Living Planet Report | Panda logo | LPI

- **WWF (World Wide Fund for Nature)** is a global conservation **NGO**, not a UN agency.
- **Headquarters** is also in **Gland, Switzerland** — same city as IUCN but **different organisation and role**.

- WWF publishes the **Living Planet Report** with the **Living Planet Index (LPI)** tracking vertebrate population (जनसंख्या) trends.
- WWF is known for the **giant panda logo** and flagship-species fundraising campaigns.
- WWF **advocates and campaigns**. IUCN **assesses** via Red List. Complementary, not identical.

Org	Output
IUCN	**Red List**
WWF	**Living Planet Report**

19.6 FAO (Environment-related Role)

Identity: Rome HQ | SOFO | Rotterdam with UNEP | ag-environment link

- **FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization)** is a UN specialised agency for **food and agriculture**.
- **Headquarters** is in **Rome, Italy**.
- FAO's environment role links **agriculture, forests, biodiversity, and land use**.
- FAO co-publishes **State of the World's Forests (SOFO)** with UNEP.
- FAO administers the **Rotterdam Convention** jointly with **UNEP** for **Prior Informed Consent (PIC)** on hazardous chemicals in trade.
- FAO work on **pesticides, forestry, and ag-biodiversity** connects farming to deforestation and habitat (वास स्थान) loss.
- FAO is **not** the publisher of HDR, Emissions Gap, or Red List.
